

KIAN RAVAEI

**THREE
NOTHINGS**

for solo violoncello

ÆI edition

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(2025)

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Commissioned by Sarah Rommel.

PROGRAM NOTE

In this piece, I make a musical effort to understand the two periods of non-existence—before and after life—as well as the in-between we call existence, so momentary and Sisyphean that it too may be called a “nothing.”

—Kian Ravaei

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

My sincerest thanks to cellists Boubacar Diallo, Robert Feifan Hurley, Dylan Kinneavy, and Sarah Rommel, whose advice was essential in the creation of this work.

duration ca. 9'

to Sarah Rommel

THREE NOTHINGS

for solo cello

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(2025)

I. After Death

Grieving, with much rubato ♩ = 50–58

p cresc. and dim. ad lib. (sempre)

4 *rit. a tempo, aching*

7 *mf rit. a tempo, somber pp*

10 *p mf rit.*

13 *f a tempo, feeling new strength*

16 *ten. rit. a tempo, tearful ff > mf > p*

19 *rit. al fine pp*

II. Sisyphus

Lumbering footsteps $\text{♩} = 54$ ($\text{♩} = 108$)

f heavy

10

20

29

Freely (sul A)

sf *p* ethereal

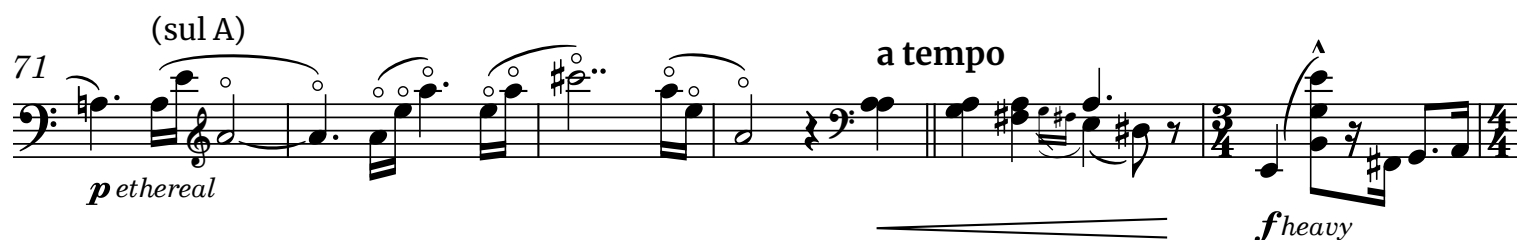
36 a tempo

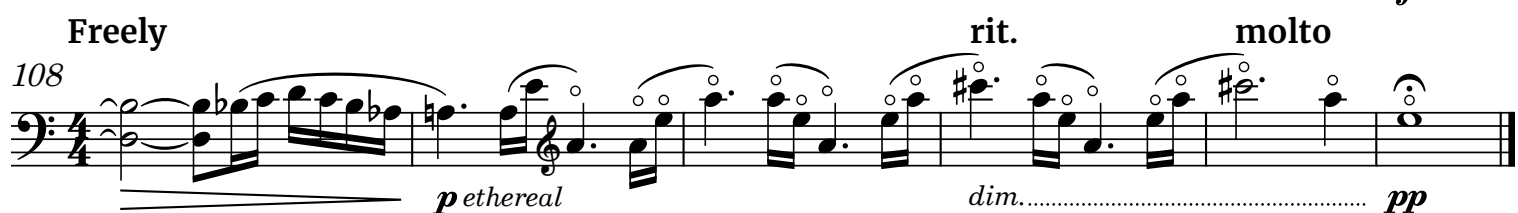
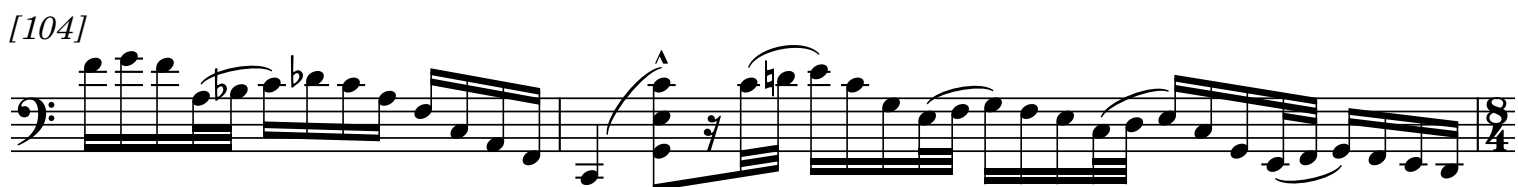
f heavy

43

49

55





III. Before Birth (Bardo)

As fast as possible $\text{♩} = 144-152$ (ben misurato)

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in bass clef, 3/2 time. It consists of 48 measures, divided into eight systems of six measures each. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). The tempo is marked 'As fast as possible' with a note value of 144-152 beats per minute, and the performance instruction '(ben misurato)' is included. The score begins with a 'V' (crescendo) marking and a 'mf' (mezzo-forte) dynamic. Measure numbers 6, 11, 16, 21, 26, 31, 36, 41, and 46 are indicated at the start of their respective systems. Measure 17 is boxed, and measure 33 is also boxed. A 'f' (forte) dynamic marking appears below the staff at measure 33. The music features a continuous eighth-note melody with frequent chromaticism and ties across measures.

51

56

ff

61

rit.

p *ff* *p*

6

66 a tempo

mf

71

76

81

82

86

91

96

101 102

f

106

111

116

121

126

ff *p* *ff* *p*

6 *6*

131 *rit.* 135 *a tempo*

ff *p* *mf*

136

141

146 (off the string)

ff

